Inside the Corner Office: The Real Story of The Bonker's Candy Factory

By Mike Beyer

(Musical intro – hum or vocalize the melody of The Candy Man by Sammy Davis, Junior)*

An empty office. Billy Bonkers strides in briskly, approaches the desk and begins writing furiously. Charles and Grandpa stick their faces through the partially open door cautiously.

CHARLES: There he is Grandpa! There's Willy Wonk – I mean, Billy!

GRANDPA: Huh?

CHARLES: Nothing. Stupid lawyers. The tour of his candy factory has taken us to his private office at last! All the other naughty children have met a nasty end, and we're the only ones left. But why isn't he inviting us in?

GRANDPA: What?

CHARLES: *(Much louder)* I said, we're the only ones left on this tour, and I – never mind. I'm going in. *(Charles enters the office and Grandpa cautiously follows)*

INTRODUCTION

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CHARLES: Mr. Bonkers, sir? *(No answer)* Sir?

BILLY: *(Unpleasant, business-like)* May I help you?

CHARLES: Well, my Grandpa and I are the only ones left on the tour, so we were wondering what happens now.

BILLY: *(Not looking up)* Yes. Well. The exit door is down the hall, second door on your left.

CHARLES: Sir, what about the five pounds of candy per day?

BILLY: Excuse me?

CHARLES: *(Taking the ticket from his pocket)* It says that everyone who completes the tour gets

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five pounds of candy every day for the rest of their lives.

BILLY: *(Snatching the ticket from Charles' hand and inspecting it)* Ah. So, it does. **HOWEVER**, it does **NOT** allow for little thieving boys and their elderly thieving grandpas!

CHARLES: We didn't steal anything!

BILLY: Really? Then you deny going into the Belchy SugarBlast Drinks room and helping yourself to a taste? Even though such tasting is strictly forbidden?

CHARLES: *(Head down)* No. We drank it.

BILLY: Aha! I knew it. Well then. If there is nothing else you require, please show yourselves **OUT**.

CHARLES: We almost died in that room! We got such a sugar rush from that drink that I almost had a heart attack! Look what your drink did to Grandpa!

GRANDPA: *(To the wall)* Hello there!

BILLY: Then I trust you have both learned a valuable lesson. And that lesson is: **DON'T TOUCH OTHER PEOPLE'S STUFF!** You don't get the five pounds of candy! You get **NOTHING**! Now goodbye!

CHARLES: But-

BILLY: I SAID GOODBYE-BYE! *(Pause)*

CHARLES: Let's go. *(He turns, takes GRANDPA by the hand, and together they prepare to exit)*

GRANDPA: Where we going now?

CHARLES: Home, and the bread and water that waits for us. *(They stop at the door, and CHARLES looks back at BILLY)* Hold on a second. *(He reaches into his pocket, goes back and places a piece of candy on BILLY'S desk then proceeds to leave)*

BILLY: *(touched)* The honesty of a child. Returning that which he could have easily kept. . . *(He whirls around)* Charles! Don't go. Please.

CHARLES: But you said the tour was over-

BILLY: I know what I said, but don't you see? This was the test! You were told to get a piece of my Molarcrusher Rock Candy and give it to my main competitor.

CHARLES: Yes. Mr. Vanilla Fudgerton told me to get a piece of this candy and he would pay

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me a million dollars and all the chocolate bacon Slurpalicious Shakes I wanted.

BILLY: Yes, and all the other children gave the pieces to Fudgerton, who secretly works for me. But not you! Don't you see what that means? It means you've won! All this will one day be yours!

CHARLES: You mean. . . I'll be president and CEO of Bonker's Candy Factory? Oh, my goodness! You don't want to do that!

BILLY: Oh, but I do. A child is the only one who can truly love fantastic items like the Oreo Cookie/Ranch Dressing Cream Puffs. A child is more open to new ideas – *(aside to audience)* and by open, I mean he'll run it exactly my way.

CHARLES: This is a dream come true! When do I start?

BILLY: No time like the present! *(He produces a contract and signs it)* Charles, when you sign this, you will be the unquestioned boss of the world-famous Bonker's Candy Factory. *(Hands the contract and pen to CHARLES. GRANDPA leans over CHARLES' shoulder and reads the contract. He gasps.)*

GRANDPA: Do it, Charles! *(Charles signs it)*

BILLY: Excellent! Fantastic! Splendid! Adjectives! Let's get into my rocket-powered elevator and grab the rest of your family!

CHARLES: *(Charles' demeanor changes)* Let's you have a seat and let the new boss do his thing!

BILLY: Excellent plan – wait a minute, what?

CHARLES: You heard me. *(BILLY sits down in his old chair)* You're sitting in my seat, Mr. Bonkers.

BILLY: Haha, you're already taking to the job! I like that. Want to go back down to my strawberry lake and eat some mango-flavored orchids?

CHARLES: No thanks. I have plans for that room! Grandpa, take a memo. *(GRANDPA takes a notebook and pen from the desk)*

GRANDPA: Go, Charles!

CHARLES: You know, Billy, I'm not feeling the name "Bonker's Candy Factory." I think a new

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name is needed. I think the name "Bonker's Organic Healthy Creations Farm" has a nice ring to it, don't you?

BILLY: Sacrilege! The name of Bonkers is known from Kalamazoo to Timbuktu! Why, children everywhere look forward to consuming my creations!

CHARLES: Yes, and thanks to your creations, obesity is at an all-time high!

BILLY: Well, that's not MY fault! It's the parents who are responsible! Children today are so SPOILED!

CHARLES: Yes, but I plan to change everything inside your company. For starters, your Bonker's Cherry Cake Batter and Double Caramel Ice Cream will now become just Bonker's Cherry Yogurt.

BILLY: *(Spluttering with rage)* You. . . you. . . Ridiculous! No one will eat it. This is an outrage!

CHARLES: The Bonker's Organic Healthy Creations Farm will help children around the world reach their true nutritious potential -- through healthy snack offerings!

BILLY: My candy is nutritious! Look how fit I am! *(He attempts to do jumping jacks. He fails. A beat)*

CHARLES: *(unimpressed)* So, as I was saying, we'll make smoothies that will cause children to **do** jumping jacks! Our chewing gum will actually remove plaque and whiten teeth! Our glazed donuts will contain more vitamins than *sugar*!

BILLY: You're mad! *(to audience)* He's ruining everything I've helped to create! I knew I should have picked the fat kid who got sucked through the tubes.

CHARLES: His Type 2 diabetes is probably irreversible. But I'll have him work for me. He can help me convert the chocolate eggs into low-calorie egg whites. He'll also lead the Bonker's Marathon Training Team!

BILLY: Charles, Charles, Charles. Before you go completely crazy and send us all to ruin, let's just talk this out first. My whole mission in life has always been to bring smiles to children's faces! To make the world taste good!

GRANDPA: Do we even need Bonkers anymore?

CHARLES: Nah. Send him down to the old Exploding Room. We'll make him a test taster of our

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Quinoa Brownie Delights.

BILLY: OK, OK, I get it! Candy equals bad! I understand now. But let me help you – I know how this factory works, and I can help you achieve your dreams!

CHARLES: I'm listening.

BILLY: OK, I promise to get rid of the High-Fructose Corn Syrup and Artificial Sweetener Room.

CHARLES: Good.

BILLY: But it helped my chocolate bars taste so delicious! Don't you like flavor?

CHARLES: Not when kids can barely climb the stairs and develop more pimples than there are stars in the sky!

BILLY: But those candy bars keep those kids from developing bad habits in life. Parents actually DEPEND on me to keep their little brats in line.

CHARLES: I'm not sure I follow you.

BILLY: You see, children need rewards to work for. What better reward than candy? No one will clean their room or eat their broccoli if the incentive is just a stupid apple.

CHARLES: Apples are not stupid! Besides, my new orchards will produce apples as big as your head. Not only that, they give you the ability to do long division problems in your head the minute after you eat them!

BILLY: Whatever! It's still an apple! They don't comfort anybody! Who's going to sit down on a lonely Saturday night for a good cry, a couple of movies, and a tub of kiwis and carrots?

CHARLES: Plenty of people, if they know they have to get up the next morning and run eight miles! We'll have Bonker's Nutrition Clubs set up worldwide!

BILLY: But can't we at least give the lazy people some Bonker's Sticky Stomach Taffy, just to give them a little break from this terrible world?

GRANDPA: Sorry, Bonkers. The jig is up.

BILLY: Grandpa? Could I perhaps interest you in a Bonker's Nut-tastic Dark Chocolate Toffee and Peanut Butter Avalanche? A parting gift from me. You won't be seeing these anymore.

GRANDPA: Well, thank you, Mr. Bonkers. *(Takes a bite.)*

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CHARLES: *Grandpa!* DON'T EAT THAT – *(They fight over the candy bar, but Grandpa is crafty and manages to pop the entire bar into his mouth)*

GRANDPA: *(with his mouth full)* Sorry, Charles. But. . . wow! I forgot how GOOD this tastes!

CHARLES: For your information, those three bites just put about 12,000 calories on your frame, and will keep five dentists employed for at least a year scraping all that toffee from your teeth!

GRANDPA: Maybe we can have one room here in the factory for candy, and the other 7,000 for your health food and juice products!

CHARLES: I don't believe what I'm hearing!

BILLY: Listen to your Grandpa, Charles. Maybe you should let him run the factory for now, until you get a little bit older.

CHARLES: No deals! Now, Grandpa PLEASE! Step away from the candy!

GRANDPA: But Charles, I haven't had one of these in years! Do you know why?

CHARLES: The last of your teeth fell out?

GRANDPA: I started listening to all the fitness and nutrition do-gooders! Shouldn't we at least still observe the time-honored tradition of dessert? In moderation?

CHARLES: We'll have candy bars! We're going to roll out Bonker's Chocolate-Flavored Edamame Krispy Krunch! The youth of tomorrow will thank us!

GRANDPA: Charles, I'm stepping in. I'm appointing myself CEO of the Bonker's Candy Factory until further notice. At first I went along with your plan, but these food creations of yours push the envelope in ways that are bad and wrong. Edamame Krispy Krunch? Gross. *(He takes the contract from the desk and rips it up)*

CHARLES: NO!!!

GRANDPA: We'll split up the factory. Billy can continue to make his fantastically magical candy, and you can start on your super-healthy goodies.

CHARLES: I suppose half-ownership of Bonkers is better than a lifetime doomed to eating cabbage soup and noodles.

BILLY: [And] I get to keep this corner office.

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CHARLES: *(pouting again as a young child)* This is so unfair! GRANDPA!

GRANDPA: Now go to your room. *(CHARLES stomps out. BILLY goes to the desk and pours two glasses)*

BILLY: *(Giving a glass to GRANDPA)* Belchy Sugar Blast?

GRANDPA: Don't mind if I do!

TOGETHER: *(Raising glass)* To health! (*They drink and both burp loudly)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

MN State Qualifier

**** Music to Candyman from Willy Wonka can be found here:***
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sizCBeS03YU

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